ASHOK G. ATHAWALE, PMP

Senior Program / Delivery Manager | AI-GenAI & Agentic AI Delivery Leader | Cloud & Digital Transformation | BFSI, Cards & Payments, Telecom, HRMS

Pune, India | ashokathawale@gmail.com | +91-8380075222 | linkedin.com/in/ashok-g-athawale-pmp-89074562

18+ Years Program & Delivery Management | PMP, SAFe & Cloud Architect

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Result-oriented Senior Program/Delivery Manager with **18+ years** of experience leading enterprise-scale cloud transformation, application migration, DevOps automation, and AI/ML & GenAI delivery across **BFSI, Fintech, and Telecom**. PMP-certified leader with a track record of managing **$10M+ portfolios** and global teams of **70+ members**, delivering platforms serving **10M+ users at 99.99% uptime**. Proven expertise executing **AWS/Azure** migrations, Kubernetes deployments, and end-to-end **GenAI, RAG-based, and MLOps** solutions, with strong grounding in Agile/Scrum/SAFe delivery, stakeholder and steering committee governance, and regulatory-compliant banking transformation across 8+ countries.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Program & Delivery Management: Agile, Scrum, SAFe, Waterfall, Hybrid Delivery, PI Planning, RAID Management, Risk & Scope Management, Stakeholder Management, Steering Committee Governance, Change Control, Vendor & Contract Management (SOW, T&M / Fixed-Bid), PMO Governance, Budget & P&L Ownership

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, CloudWatch, VPC, IAM), Azure (Azure DevOps, Azure VM, App Service, Functions, Virtual Network, Load Balancer, Application Gateway, Container Registry), GCP, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (AKS), Helm Charts, Terraform, Infrastructure-as-Code, RBAC

DevOps & CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Azure Pipelines, Release Management, Build & Deployment Automation, Configuration Management

AI / GenAI & Data: Generative AI, Agentic AI, LLMs (GPT-4o, Claude, Gemini, Azure OpenAI), LangChain, LangGraph, Semantic Kernel, AI Agents & Multi-Agent Orchestration, Vector Databases (Pinecone, Azure AI Search), Prompt Engineering, AI Governance & Responsible AI, MLOps, Data Engineering, ETL Pipelines, Model Training & Deployment.

Agentic RAG | LangGraph | RAG | LLM | Pinecone | Vector Search | Embeddings | Query Routing | Evidence Grading | Query Rewriting | Web Search Fallback | FastAPI | Python | Docker | DigitalOcean | CI/CD | AI Governance | Auditability | Traceability

Domain Expertise: BFSI, Cards & Payments, Digital Banking, Payment Processing (UPI, SWIFT), Virtual Cards, Credit Cards, Authentication (Auth-U, C-Tap, CTAP, FIDO2), Fraud Detection, Telecom Infrastructure, HRMS, Fintech

Technical Stack: Java, Spring / Spring Boot, Python, C++, .NET, Microservices Architecture, REST APIs, API Gateway & API Management, JavaScript, Bash/Shell Scripting, PowerShell, JSON, YAML, XML, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Load Balancing, CDN, VPN, ExpressRoute, Firewall

System Design & Architecture: HLD/LLD, Distributed Systems, Scalable & High-Availability Architecture, Microservices, API Design, Load Balancing, Caching, Database Replication & Sharding, CAP Theorem, Horizontal/Vertical Scaling, API Gateway, CDN, Message Queues, Fault Tolerance, Disaster Recovery, Performance & Capacity Planning, Security & Resilience Testing, AI-Assisted Software Architecture

Data Platform & Engineering: Data Platform Delivery, Data Lakehouse, Data Warehouse Modernization, ETL/ELT, Data Ingestion, Data Integration, Data Transformation, Data Pipeline Orchestration, Medallion Architecture, Data Modeling, Semantic/Serving Models, Data Quality, Data Reconciliation, Data Lineage, Data Governance, Data Cataloging, MDM, Data Observability

Data & Cloud Technologies: Azure Data Factory, Azure Data Lake Storage Gen2, Azure Databricks, Apache Spark, Azure Synapse Analytics, Microsoft Fabric, Power BI, Azure, SQL

ITIL & Service Management: Service Desk & Ticket Management, SLA/OLA Management, CMDB, Incident, Problem, Change, CAB, and Release Management

Collaboration & PM Tools: JIRA, Confluence, MS Project, ServiceNow, Kanban Boards, Sprint & Release Planning Dashboards

Compliance & Governance: PCI-DSS, Data Privacy & Residency Compliance, Regulatory Reporting, Audit & Risk Controls (banking/payments context)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Project Manager

Giesecke+Devrient India Pvt. Ltd., Pune | June 2022 – June 2026

- Direct end-to-end delivery of a multi-product BFSI portfolio (Convego Auth-U, C-Tap, Virtual Card) for global clients across many countries, integrating AI/ML and automation frameworks into fintech solutions.
- Own an annual **$5M+ project budget** with full P&L accountability, ensuring **100% on-time delivery** across **10+ concurrent projects**.
- Lead cross-functional teams of **30+ resources** (development, QA, DevOps) across multiple time zones, with direct project health and technical progress reporting to C-suite executives.
- Piloted GenAI/RAG proof-of-concepts (OpenAI, LangChain, Pinecone) for internal and client use cases, positioning delivery organization for emerging AI governance requirements.

Project Manager / Delivery Manager

Wipro Technologies, Pune | March 2018 – June 2022

- Executed large-scale program management and vendor coordination for enterprise clients, managing multiple concurrent delivery pipelines.
- Led Agile transformation initiatives that improved delivery efficiency and predictability across program teams.
- Managed global teams of **70+ members** across multi-country, multi-vendor delivery environments.

Global Delivery Head / Project Manager

ModeFinServer, Bangalore | July 2015 – February 2018

- Spearheaded market entry for cloud-based mobile and agency banking solutions across **8 African countries**, serving **5M+ customers**.
- Optimized delivery through Agile transformation and streamlined deployment cycles across multiple concurrent country rollouts.
- Reported delivery insights and program milestones directly to C-suite stakeholders across multiple markets.

Project Lead / Delivery Manager

Tech Mahindra Ltd., Pune | May 2011 – June 2015

- Managed telecom transformation projects for AT&T (USA) and Vodafone (Australia), maintaining 99.9% uptime for mission-critical applications.
- Utilized a Hybrid Waterfall/Agile approach to manage Linux/Unix and Java-based enterprise environments.

EARLIER CAREER

- Steria India Ltd (Xansa), Pune — Software Engineer | Aug 2008 – May 2011
- CDAC India, Pune — Member Technical Staff | Jan 2007 – Jul 2008

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered platforms serving **10M+ users** at **99.99% uptime** across BFSI and Telecom portfolios.
- Executed cloud transformation programs spanning **AWS, Azure, and GCP**.
- Led adoption of AI/ML and GenAI strategies into enterprise and fintech systems.

GENAI PROJECTS

1. Project: Medical Chatbot (GenAI PoC)

Built a **RAG-based chatbot** using OpenAI, LangChain, and Pinecone with a Flask backend for context-aware medical query handling, ingesting a 700-page medical reference book as the knowledge base.

2. Project: Internal HR Chatbot

Built a **RAG-based chatbot** using OpenAI, LangChain, and Pinecone with a Flask backend for context-aware, self-service HR query resolution across internal HR policy documentation.

3. Project: IT Companies IT Support Agentic RAG Co-Pilot
Designed an **Agentic RAG-based Enterprise IT Support Co-Pilot** to provide employees with accurate, contextual and evidence-backed answers using internal enterprise knowledge.

- Designed an end-to-end **Agentic AI architecture using LangGraph**, incorporating query routing, knowledge retrieval, evidence grading, query rewriting, web-search fallback and grounded response generation.
- Implemented a **multi-format knowledge ingestion pipeline** supporting PDF, Markdown, TXT and DOC documents, including text extraction, chunking, embeddings and vector indexing.
- Integrated **Pinecone Vector Database** for scalable semantic/vector search with namespace-based data segregation.
- Integrated **OpenAI GPT models and embedding models** for natural-language understanding, generation and semantic retrieval.
- Implemented **LLM-based evidence grading** to evaluate retrieved internal and external information before generating responses.

EDUCATION

- MBA — ICFAI, Hyderabad
- Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Science — SGGS College of Engineering
- Bachelor of Laws (LLB) — Shri Shivaji Maratha Law College, Pune

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMP — Project Management Professional, PMI
- Generative AI for Project Managers — PMI
- AI for Project Managers — PMI
- Knowledge on SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework)
- Knowledge on Azure/AWS/GCP Cloud